WORKPLACE PENSIONS · UK

Your employer puts money in too.

In a job on payroll, 8% of your qualifying earnings goes into a pension: 3% from your employer and 5% from you. Those are the legal minimums. Leave the scheme and the employer's share is not replaced.

WHO IS ENROLLED AUTOMATICALLY · 2026/27

£10,000

Your employer has to put you in without being asked if you are classed as a ‘worker’, aged between 22 and State Pension age, earn at least £10,000 a year, and usually work in the UK.

> ‘Worker’ is wider than payroll: agency and casual work can count. In most automatic enrolment schemes only £6,240 to £50,270 of pay counts.

WHO IS NOT ENROLLED AUTOMATICALLY · 2026/27

Under 22, over State Pension age, or under £10,000 a year. From 16 to 74 you can usually ask to join and your employer cannot refuse. At £6,240 a year or less it need not pay in — but it must still deduct your own contribution and pay it into the scheme. **Above £6,240, ask to join and it must pay in too.**

> The employer's legal minimum, 3%, is worked out on qualifying earnings, not your whole wage. Sole director, no other staff: no duty at all.

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Not sure whether you are enrolled?

Message us and we will send you the official GOV.UK page with the rules. No obligation.

0330 133 1886

General information, not pensions advice. The conditions are on gov.uk.